My real life system

THIS PLAN BELONGS TO
Wenda Benavidez

Four homes, one weekly sort, and one job for each tool. Keep this where you plan.

My 4 parts

Each part gets one job.

Inbox

Where new stuff lands first.

MY INBOX LIVES IN
A brain dump page in my planner

BACKUP SPOT WHEN I'M OUT
A note on my phone

Calendar

Anything with a date or a time.

MY CALENDAR LIVES IN
A calendar app on my phone

WHO ELSE NEEDS TO SEE IT
My partner and the whole family, shared...

Tasks

To-dos with no set time.

MY TASKS LIVE IN
A task app

HOW I MARK WHAT'S NEXT
I star it and put my top 3 on my daily page

Notes

Info and ideas to keep.

MY NOTES LIVE IN
A notes app with folders

HOW I FIND THINGS LATER
One folder per project

My weekly sort time

A set time to empty your inbox into the calendar, tasks, and notes.

DAY
Sunday

TIME
7:30 pm

WHERE
The couch

My tools

Each tool gets one job. Nothing gets planned in two places.

I USE IT	TOOL	ITS ONE JOB
☑	**Paper planner**	*My top 3, my brain dump, and my week at a glance*
☑	**Digital calendar**	*Appointments and anything with a time*
☑	**Wall calendar**	*What the whole family needs to see*
☑	**Task or project app**	*Everything to do that has no set time*
☐	**Notes app**	*Info and ideas to keep*

My night before

Decide tomorrow tonight, so there is nothing to talk yourself out of.

- ☐ *Set out my clothes*
- ☐ *Plan my meal*
- ☐ *Fill my water bottle*
- ☐ *Write tomorrow's top 3*

ON A DAY I DON'T FEEL LIKE IT, I'LL JUST
do one loop around the neighborhood

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My systems

One small system per card. Small enough to do on a tired Tuesday.

FOCUS AREA 1: *Meals*

FOCUS AREA 2: *Kids and family*

FOCUS AREA 3: *Work or business*

SYSTEM 1 NAME: *Evening launch pad*

AREA: *Home*

THE DECISION THIS REPLACES: *"What do we need today?" during the morning rush*

TRIGGER. WHEN DOES IT START?: *Right after dinner cleanup*

WHERE IT LIVES

☐ Inbox ☐ Calendar ☐ Tasks ☐ Notes

A routine card at the back of my planner

LOW-ENERGY VERSION: *Pack the bags and pick my top 3*

THE STEPS. FIVE OR FEWER.

1. *Clear the sink*
2. *Prep the coffee and set it to brew on its own*
3. *Fill water bottles and pack bags*
4. *Set out tomorrow's clothes*
5. *Open my planner, block my time, pick my top 3*

SYSTEM 2 NAME: *Dinner rotation*

AREA: *Meals*

THE DECISION THIS REPLACES: *"What's for dinner?" every afternoon*

TRIGGER. WHEN DOES IT START?: *My Sunday reset*

WHERE IT LIVES

☐ Inbox ☑ Calendar ☐ Tasks ☑ Notes

Calendar for the Sunday block. Notes for the go-to...

LOW-ENERGY VERSION: *Repeat last week's plan*

THE STEPS. FIVE OR FEWER.

1. *Pick 5 meals from our go-to list*
2. *Check the calendar for busy nights*
3. *Order the groceries*
4. *Post the plan on the fridge*
5.

SYSTEM 3 NAME: *School paper tray*

AREA: *Kids and family*

THE DECISION THIS REPLACES: *"Where did that form go?"*

TRIGGER. WHEN DOES IT START?: *The kids walk in the door*

WHERE IT LIVES

☑ Inbox ☑ Calendar ☐ Tasks ☐ Notes

Inbox is the tray by the door. Dates go on the calendar.

LOW-ENERGY VERSION: *Dates on the calendar only. The rest waits until tomorrow.*

THE STEPS. FIVE OR FEWER.

1. *Papers go in the tray by the door*
2. *I check the tray after dinner*
3. *Dates go on the calendar*
4. *Signed forms go back in the backpack*
5.

My floor plan

The floor always counts. Do it and you showed up today.

Floor and More

Every habit gets three sizes. On a low day, the floor is the win.

HABIT OR SYSTEM	FLOOR	REGULAR	BONUS
Example: Reading	*One page*	*20 minutes*	*An hour with tea*
Move my body	*Shoes on, 5 minutes*	*20 minutes*	*45 minutes*

My minimum viable day

Five small things that keep life moving.

- ☐ *Drink water*
- ☐ *Write my top 3 in my planner*
- ☐ *Do one deep work task*
- ☐ *Move my body for 20 minutes*
- ☐ *Quick tidy before bed*

WHAT CAN WAIT ON A HARD DAY

Folding laundry, the inbox at zero, and anything that needs more than ten minutes of thinking

After a rough week

Pick it back up right where it is.

1. **Name what happened.**
   Facts only. No blame.
2. **Pick one system to restart.**
   The one you miss the most.
3. **Do the floor version today.**
   Write the one step here.
4. **Choose when you will do it again.**
   A day and a time.

My 10-minute restart

- ☐ *Clean one surface*
- ☐ *Brain dump*
- ☐ *Reset my planner*

My excuse answers

Pick your answer ahead of time, so you can skip the debate.

"I'll do it tomorrow."	*I do one minute. One minute counts.*
"I already missed a few days."	*Today is day one again. I do today's floor and keep going.*
"I don't have time for the whole thing."	*I do the floor. The whole thing can wait for a bigger day.*
"I need to plan it all out first."	*I take the next step with what I know. The plan can fill in as I go.*
"I'm too tired."	*I do the smallest version, then rest. Both count.*

THIS WEEK **1** Weekly reset on Sunday **2** Run my first system for two weeks **3** Hard day? Floor first.